their ties with Jordan and the Gulf countries. "Eurabia," as the Egyptian-born writer Bat Ye'or has called it, took shape:

> A geo-political reality envisaged in 1973 through a system of informal alliances between, on the one hand, the nine countries of the European Community (EC) which, enlarged, became the European Union (EU) in 1992, and on the other hand, the Mediterranean Arab countries.[15]

All members of the European Community started to distance themselves from Israel and instead to align their interests with those of the Arab world. At the same time, the United States saw that Israel could be a strategic asset in the Middle East. America started to support Israel seriously after 1967, and during the next few decades, its help increased very significantly. This alliance between Israel and the United States, however, often fluctuated. Israel frequently found itself under American pressure which was too heavy to resist.

When Egypt's President Anwar al-Sadat decided to cut Egypt's ties with the Soviet Union and align his country with the United States, the Carter administration encouraged Israel in the direction of a peace treaty that could be acceptable to Sadat. In 1978, Israel's Prime Minister Menachem Begin signed a text acknowledging the "legitimate rights of the Palestinian people." Peace with Egypt was a strategic asset for Israel, but the recognition by Israel of the "legitimate rights of the Palestinian people" has had complex consequences. The pressure continued during the presidency of George H. W. Bush ("Bush 41"), who thought that he could establish a "new world order." He tried to force the Israeli government to sign a peace agreement allowing the fulfillment of "Palestinian rights." The result was the Madrid conference of 1991 from which, two years later, the Oslo Accords followed, backed by U.S. President Bill Clinton.

The Oslo Accords were supposed to bring peace, but instead they led to countless attacks on Israelis by Palestinians, and hundreds of injuries and deaths. A separate peace treaty was signed with Jordan in 1994, but the price Israel had to pay was the de facto recognition of the PLO's demand to create and take administrative control over an independent "Palestinian state" in Judea and Samaria, on the "West Bank" of the Jordan River. The Palestinian Authority (PA) was formed the same year, 1994, as a "self-governing body." But, in total contravention of the Oslo Accords, it did not renounce violence. Terrorist attacks from territories ruled by the PA stopped only a decade later when the Israelis finally built a security barrier to make it more difficult to blow up buses, hotels, cafés, and discothèques. To this day, the PA has not ceased praising, promoting, and even glorifying terrorist attacks on Israeli civilians.

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